

Setup & Environment Guide

Everything you need to get up and running.

Before the interview, we recommend getting familiar with Databricks. The interview will take place in **Databricks Free Edition**, which offers a fully serverless version of Databricks with a few features rate-limited/throttled to make it free for everyone to use.

1. If you don't already have a Databricks account, please sign up for the [Free Edition here](#) using the email address we have on file with your application.
2. At the start of the interview, you will receive access to a Google Drive folder with instructions and pre-built assets that will need to be deployed into your workspace using Declarative Automation Bundles (DABs). More information on DABs can be found below.
3. After completing the interview, please refrain from distributing or publicizing the assignment to maintain the integrity of the process. We also ask that you sign the NDA that was sent separately through DocuSign.
4. To ensure a smooth experience, please minimize distractions & use a stable internet connection.

You'll only have 4 hours to complete the prompt once provided, so **come ready**. Make sure your environment is set up and working before the session starts. We won't be able to extend time for tooling issues or environment troubleshooting, so test your setup in advance and know your workflow.

The build is a prop — not the main event. **25%** of your score comes from your demo; the other **75%** comes from how you diagnose the situation, frame the business impact, and navigate the room. If you're spending most of your prep time building, you're optimizing for the wrong thing. Finish the build early, then invest the rest of your time

sharpening your story: the "so what," the customer connection, and the case you'd make to a skeptical audience about what to do next and why.

Questions? Please reach out to your recruiter directly.

What You Can Use

The Databricks Free Edition Workspace is required. After that's setup, pick whatever AI tool(s) fit your style. Here's a quick overview of common approaches — all equally valid:

Tool / Approach	When it makes sense
Databricks (built-in)	You will diagnose and build within Databricks using Notebooks, Agents, Genie, and more — no local setup required. Sign up for a Databricks Free account here and familiarize yourself with it so you can hit the ground running once you receive the prompt. By signing up for this free account, you agree to our Databricks Free Edition Terms and Privacy Notice. NEW! Free Edition Credit Boost: Candidates who hit their Free Edition limit mid-build can claim a Credit Boost ("Unlock account" in the top nav, max 1/day and 3/year) to keep working — more compute doesn't mean a better score, but it's there if they need it. Click here for more details.

Your own AI setup	Already have a workflow you trust? Start there. Any IDE, notebook runner, cloud environment, or AI assistant you're effective with is completely fair game.
Cursor / VS Code	Prefer a visual coding environment? Pair your IDE with an AI assistant for a smooth build-and-iterate loop. Works well for Python, notebooks, and multi-file projects.
Claude Code	Comfortable in the terminal? Great for rapidly scaffolding notebooks, SQL, and pipelines from natural language prompts. Strong choice for CLI-first candidates.

One Way to Approach It (If You Want a Starting Point)

Not sure where to begin? Here's one workflow candidates have successfully used. It uses Claude inside Cursor as an AI pair for the build, then deploys into Databricks for the demo. Feel free to adapt any part of it — or ignore it entirely if you've got your own flow.

1	Databricks project scaffold
→	You will receive a project scaffold and partial implementation via a zip file (located in Google Drive) that needs to be deployed to your Databricks workspace via DABs . The project scaffold includes README.md, SETUP.md, FAQ.md, and AI_WORKFLOWS.md. These files are meant for AI context but can be helpful if you need quick orientation or get stuck.
2	Build and iterate — in your editor of choice
→	Prompt your AI assistant to refine logic, adjust schemas, add error handling

3	Deploy and present
→	Get your solution running in a way you can demo live — the platform matters less than being able to walk us through it clearly
→	Add a presentation layer, a dashboard, a Genie Space, an app, or even just a clean notebook output

Databricks Resources

Sign Up for Databricks Free Edition

If you don't already have a Databricks account, [follow these steps](#) to get setup and deploy your workspace.

Databricks Products & Features

Familiarize yourself with the following concepts as they will be referenced in the prompt. Learning about them ahead of time will help you during your 4-hour build window:

- [System Tables](#)
- [Unity Catalog](#)
- [Lakeflow Connect](#)
- [Compute Policies](#)
- [Serverless SQL](#)
- [Declarative Automation Bundles \(DABs\)](#)

Databricks AI-Dev-Kit

If you want a structured jumping-off point to build in your Databricks workspace, the AI-Dev-Kit is a purpose-built toolkit for rapidly prototyping Databricks AI solutions. It's **completely optional** — but handy if you want MCP servers to call Databricks assets.



[GitHub](#)



[Walkthrough video](#)